

Erie Shore could become part of Lake Erie

Six area schools will meet Feb. 12 to discuss joining Cuyahoga league

Jerry Rombach
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — It's appropriate Broglio's Restaurant is in Independence.

That's because on Feb. 12 at a meeting in the restaurant six members of the Erie Shore Conference will be discussing an act of independence from local-only affiliation to tie up with a large Greater Cleveland area group, the Lake Erie League.

Dr. Charles Shaddows, principal at Cleveland Heights High and president of the Lake Erie League, said the six schools have been invited to send representatives to explore the possibility of

joining the league.

Elyria, Admiral King, Southview, Midview, North Ridgeville and Vermilion all will be at the meeting. They have sent either letters of inquiry to the league or made telephone contact.

Elyria was once a member of the Lake Erie, for 25 years from 1927 through 1952, along with Lorain High. But the two schools withdrew to form the Buckeye Conference in 1955. That league dissolved with the formation of the Erie Shore in 1986. But now the Erie Shore is falling apart because Sandusky withdrew to enter a league in the west part of Ohio.

The Lake Erie now has 10 members divided into two divisions, "Lake" with larger schools

Cleveland Heights, Mentor, Lakewood, Cleveland Shaw and Parma Valley Forge, and "Erie" for smaller schools Shaker Heights, Parma Senior, Warrensville, Parma Normandy and Garfield Heights. Even the smaller schools are big enough to be Division I, the premier class of competition in Ohio.

The two divisions do not have a playoff at the end of the season.

"We haven't discounted the possibility of the league re-forming its divisions to East-West to accommodate the Lorain County teams," Lake Erie League executive secretary Ed Dohanos said.

Or, the league could decide to stay with the bigger and smaller Division I team setup, with the larger Elyria, Admiral King and

Southview going into the Lake Division with Cleveland Heights, Mentor, Lakewood, Shaw and Valley Forge and the smaller Midview, North Ridgeville and Vermilion going with Erie Division schools Shaker Heights, Parma, Warrensville, Normandy and Garfield Heights.

Dr. Shaddows pointed out that no official action would be taken at the February meeting.

"We are in the preliminary stages of discussions," he said. "But we are very much interested in expansion. Our ideal would be to have seven or eight teams in each division. I can see such a league being acclaimed state wide as one of the greatest high school alignments in Ohio."

With the merger of Elyria

High and Elyria West, the school will have up to 2,400 students which will put it in the same enrollment class with Cleveland Heights, Mentor and Lakewood, among the largest in the state.

Another league with an opening is the Pioneer. On Jan. 12 Cloverleaf formally withdrew to join the Suburban League after next school year.

"We're having an emergency meeting Wednesday (today) to discuss our course of action," Pioneer Conference Membership Chairman Gordon Billman, Berea principal, said. "We have had no inquiries from any school. What we will do is prepare a draft inviting schools to apply, with a March 1 deadline."

"There is a lot of talk about

such and such school coming to the Pioneer. I read the other day that Valley Forge had a lock on the league. I really laughed at that one. Nobody has even applied so how could anybody have a lock?"

Today the Lorain County Conference is also having a meeting in Lorain to accept a school to replace Elyria West. Columbia High of the MAC-8 is one of the applicants.

Another rumor has North Olmsted leaving the Southwestern Conference to join the Pioneer.

"There's no truth to that at all," North Olmsted Athletic Director Tim Flannery said. "We are perfectly happy in the SWC. Our so-called interest in the Pioneer is just 'creative' interest by some people."

BOYS BASKETBALL

Mosby does better off the bench

Kevin Aprile
The Chronicle-Telegram

GRAFTON — Ray Verba and his Midview Middies were without center Drake Mosby for the first 10 games of the season.

They went 1-9.

Tuesday the Middies won for the third time in the four games since Mosby's return from a broken finger, beating Avon 47-38 in a non-conference game.

And yet, with the game on the line, Verba contemplated sitting the 6-foot-6 junior. Turns out he was glad he didn't.

Mosby scored a game-high 13 points, including the Middies' final six of the game. His free throw with 38 seconds left pushed Midview's lead to 42-38 and he nailed two more with 27 seconds to go to make the score 44-38. He scored inside, was fouled and converted the three-point play at the 10-second mark to close out the scoring.

So why was he about to ride the pine? How's this for irony?

Free throw shooting.

With 1:46 to play and Midview ahead just 39-35, Mosby missed both ends of a two-shot foul, the second attempt missing everything. After that it was clear Avon was going to pick on him down the stretch if the Eagles needed to send someone to the line.

They did — and Mosby responded.

"He came through and made the next one," Verba said of Mosby, whose free throws with 38 seconds to go came after the Eagles purposely put him on the line. "We were thinking about taking him out, but I thought if we came down and didn't score we'd need him on defense."

Mosby's contributions were sporadic, albeit key. He scored five points in the first quarter, then didn't score again until midway through the fourth. Of course, he sat most of the third after picking up his third foul a minute into the half.

He also grabbed a game-high seven rebounds and blocked four shots, all in the first half. The

blocks definitely bothered the Eagles, who started altering their shots. Of course, the Eagles had their own problems inside as both their starting post players — Doug Hayden, a 6-3 senior, and Jeff Benson, a 6-0 junior — struggled with early foul problems. Both ended up fouling out, as did point guard Steve Vega.

"In the 10 games he was out, we had nothing inside," Verba said, noting that junior Chad Price (12 points) did a solid job Tuesday with Mosby on the bench. "Drake is a presence."

Then again, even when Mosby was out of the game Avon couldn't take advantage. Time after time in the second half the Eagles had the advantage off the break or easy inside shots only to come away empty.

"They missed a lot of cheap stuff in the third and fourth quarter," Verba said of the Eagles, who shot just 31 percent from the field to Midview's 38 percent. "They were stuck on 35 (points) a long time. I don't know if we had anything to do with that. I'd like to think we did."

"They had a bad cold spell and

we managed to rebound the ball. I'll give us that."

Vega scored four of his team-high 12 points to open the fourth quarter, tying the score at 35 with 6:16 remaining. The Eagles didn't score again until Nick Snaveley's 3-pointer with 46 seconds to play. Still, that cut the Middies' lead to 41-38, but Avon turned the ball over on its final four possessions.

That was the story of the game for the Eagles: missed chances. The postgame, too, as Avon coach Dave Kudela missed his chance to offer any explanation for the Eagles' stumbles down the stretch.

"Not tonight, guys," Kudela said as he walked past reporters after the Eagles fell to 6-6 with their third loss in four games. "Just don't feel like it tonight."

Avon					Midview				
G	F	T	3P	FT	G	F	T	3P	FT
Jonas	1	1	3	0	Ky. Crawford	2	2	2	7
Gueron	4	1	10	0	Klan	1	0	2	2
Vega	5	2	12	0	Ky. Crawford	4	0	8	0
Benson	0	4	4	0	Dennis	3	0	6	0
Hayden	2	0	4	0	Mosby	2	9	13	0
S. Crawford	2	0	4	0	Phan	3	5	11	0
Snaveley	1	0	3	0	Shabazz	0	0	0	0
Turner	0	0	0	0	Turner	0	0	0	0
Totals	16	4	38	0	Totals	15	16	47	0

Points by Quarters					
1	2	3	4	T	
Avon	13	6	10	7	36
Midview	12	12	11	12	47

Three-point goals: Avon, Mosby — Kyle Crawford. JV score, Avon 33-30.



LINDA MURPHY/CHRONICLE

UP FOR TWO Robert Sweet of Lake Ridge goes up to score two of his 16 points.

Brookside hands Lutheran West first loss

ROCKY RIVER — Poor shooting spelled trouble for Lutheran West, which fell behind early against Brookside and could not catch up in a 64-59 non-conference loss.

The setback was the first of the season for the Longhorns (10-1, 8-0 Metropolitan Area Conference), who are ranked 12th in the state in Division III in the Associated Press' state poll released today.

Jon Wright's 20 points led the assault for the Cardinals (2-9, 1-6

Lorain County Conference), who have won two games in a row after dropping their first nine decisions. Brent Williams added 20 for Brookside.

Lutheran West was paced by Phil Argento's 16 points.

Brookside will look to continue its hot streak at LCC unbeaten Elyria West Friday.

Brookside					LWest				
G	F	T	3P	FT	G	F	T	3P	FT
Wright	7	2	20	0	Williams	1	0	2	4
Williams	5	3	17	0	Kocak	2	2	4	2
Mahon	3	2	8	0	Argento	5	1	16	0
Pace	2	2	7	0	Risley	3	4	7	0
Neil	5	4	12	0	Piogetra	4	5	11	0
					Fenn	5	5	13	0
					Miler	3	1	6	0

Totals					Totals					
23	13	54	0	59	24	18	59	0		
Points by Quarters					Points by Quarters					
1	2	3	4	T	1	2	3	4	T	
Brookside	19	21	8	18	59	Lutheran West	15	15	13	17

Three-point goals: Brookside 4 (Mahon 2, Wright, Williams), Lutheran West 3 (Fenn, Risley, Argento). Junior Varsity: Lutheran West, 46-40.

Olmsted Falls.....89
Avon Lake.....39

OLMSTED FALLS — The Bulldogs sprinted to first half leads of 25-8 and 46-17 en route to a thrashing of Avon Lake.

Olmsted Falls, first in the

SWC, hosts second-place Amherst Friday.

Avon Lake					Offals				
G	F	T	3P	FT	G	F	T	3P	FT
Stauch	1	0	3	0	Stony	5	0	11	0
Petys	4	2	14	0	Hogge	1	2	4	0
Matt Lora	2	0	4	0	Matus	1	0	7	0
Jasha	1	0	2	0	Talbot	0	0	1	0
Mark Lora	4	0	8	0	Mora	0	0	4	0
Hille	1	0	2	0	Moore	0	2	2	0
Waltz	1	1	3	0	Skyer	0	0	2	0
Johnson	0	2	3	0	Neumeyer	1	1	1	0
Burke	0	0	2	0	Kalenka	2	3	7	0
Schaefer	1	0	2	0	Schaefer	9	6	24	0
Totals	15	5	35	0	Totals	32	13	85	0

Points by Quarters					
1	2	3	4	T	
Avon Lake	8	9	7	15	39
Olmsted Falls	25	21	28	15	89

Three-point goals: Avon Lake 5 (Petys 4, Stauch), Olmsted Falls 7 (Talbot, Matus, Stony). Junior Varsity: Olmsted Falls, 60-46.

Home court makes a major difference

Scott Petrak
Chronicle-Telegram

NORTH RIDGEVILLE — What a difference a month makes.

On Dec. 16 Elyria First Baptist beat Lake Ridge Academy 77-67. Tuesday night Lake Ridge returned the favor on its home court with a 66-54 Western Reserve Conference win that wasn't that close.

The Royals (4-8, 3-2) earned their third straight win behind true shooting and tough rebounding.

Lake Ridge shot 54 percent from the field, while the Sabres (5-7, 1-4) were held to 40 percent overall and just 5 of 23 from 3-point range.

"We did a lot of soul searching as a team," said Lake Ridge coach Jim Piazza of the team's transformation. "We had a sit-down talk and opened everything out and asked ourselves what we wanted to accomplish this year."

"I challenged them. And these kids have really reached down inside and are just playing hard."

Sophomore forward Tom Sparrow led the way for the Royals, scoring 30 points on 13 of 19 shooting from the field, including 4 for 7 from beyond the arc.

"(Sparrow) worked really hard in the off-season," Piazza said. "He's become one of the top play-

ers in this area."

Lake Ridge outrebounded the Sabres 32-20 and 9-5 on the offensive glass. Bob Sweet led the Royals with 10 boards. He also netted 16 and had six steals.

"Bob Sweet's probably our team MVP as far as offensively, defensively and rebounding," Piazza said. "He's our team leader as far as emotion, getting kids together."

"Our goal going in was to contain Tom Sparrow," Sabres' coach Ray Cox said. "We set up our defense to trap him, and yet the trap never got there in time. We knew if he had that open look, he'd put them in, and he did."

As a team, the Royals shot 8 of 10 from the floor for the quarter, including 2 of 2 from 3-point range.

Lake Ridge hosts Christian Community Thursday and First Baptist visits Lutheran East Friday.

Baptist					LRidge				
G	F	T	3P	FT	G	F	T	3P	FT
Stedman	4	3	12	0	Sparrow	13	0	30	0
Vance	3	0	8	0	Leggett	3	1	7	0
Va'd	3	2	13	0	Gale	0	0	0	0
Dave	0	5	5	0	Mosley	1	0	2	0
Kah	1	0	3	0	Sweet	7	2	18	0
Woodward	4	1	9	0	Hurd	1	0	2	0
Evans	2	0	4	0	Molinger	0	4	4	0
					Sedore	2	0	5	0
Totals	19	11	54	0	Totals	27	7	66	0

Points by Quarters					
1	2	3	4	T	
First Baptist	8	16	17	16	57
Lake Ridge	15	13	18	18	64

Three-point goals: First Baptist, Vance 2, Stedman, Kah, Vandergrout; Lake Ridge, Sparrow 4, Sedore. JV: No JV.

Keystone hits with inside-outside KO punch

Jason Skoda
The Chronicle-Telegram

LAGRANGE — At first glance, the Keystone boys basketball roster can be rather imposing with six players listed at 6-foot or taller.

And once opposing teams start filling up the lane to defend players like 6-foot-8 Jack Radway, Rob Beckham (6-7) and Nate Poulton (6-4), the "smaller" players like Mike Klineck (6-3) take advantage.

And it was Klineck, who scored 15 points with three

3-pointers, who helped the Wildcats defeat visiting non-league opponent Buckeye 69-61 Tuesday night.

"We hadn't played anybody with that kind of size," said Bucks first-year coach John Marhefka. "It totally affected the way we defended and the pace of the game."

"And then once we started to push them away from the basket, (Klineck) started to hit from the outside."

In the third quarter, the senior guard hit his second 3-pointer of the period to increase the Wildcats (7-6) lead to 51-41 with 1:27

remaining in the stanza. The bats ended a 6-0 run by the Bucks (4-9) in which junior guard Nick Andrukat, who tallied 15 points overall, scored all of Buckeye's points.

"It's like oh no ... OK, good shot," said Keystone coach Greg Morgan. "He is coming off a cold streak, but he shot well and it opened up the inside for us in the second half."

In steps Beckham, who scored a game-high 18 points, off the bench. Beckham had started the Wildcats previous 12 games, but was replaced by Radway.

"He showed senior leadership

because he accepted the role and came off the bench and made a great contribution," Morgan said. "We just wanted to give Radway a look because he is only a sophomore."

Keystone					Buckeye				
G	F	T	3P	FT	G	F	T	3P	FT
Backlund	5	4	18	0	Davenport	5	5	18	0
Kennedy	4	4	14	0	Andrukat	8	1	15	0
Poulton	5	3	13	0	Shaw	3	4	10	0
Radway	2	6	13	0	Anders	3	0	8	0
Radway	4	0	8	0	Hansberg	2	2	6	0
Johnson	0	2	2	0	Dolski	0	0	1	1
Shaw	0	1	1	0	Horton	1	0	2	0
Smith	0	0	0	0	Park	1	0	3	0
Totals	25	26	65	0	Totals	27	14	61	0

Points by Quarters					
1	2	3	4	T	
Keystone	12	17	15	17	61
Buckeye	15	22	14	18	69

Three-point goals: Klineck, Davenport 3, Andrukat 2, Knapp. Junior Varsity: Keystone 65, Buckeye 54.

Open Door out-hustles visiting Columbia

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — Old fashioned hustle won a basketball game for Open Door Christian Tuesday night.

The Patriots scrambled after every loose ball and rebound and pestered Columbia's offense all night in posting their sixth win in 11 starts, 56-50. Columbia fell to 4-7 overall with the non-conference loss.

"We have five fairly athletic guys," said Open Door coach Darrel Duncel. "It's hard to press us. Regardless of how they play, they always play real hard. They have hearts of gold."

Open Door opened a 12-point advantage in the first half purely with hustle and desire. The Patriots forced Columbia into a dozen turnovers and drew foul after

Open Door					Columbia				
G	F	T	3P	FT	G	F	T	3P	FT
Walt	7	8	23	0	Patzner	6	5	16	0
Turnick	5	1	11	0	Monken	5	0	11	0
Deleathis	2	5	10	0	Wolfe	4	0	9	0
Newbold	3	2	8	0	Skor	1	0	6	0
Lauren	1	0	2	0	Kelly	1	3	5	0
Shaw	1	0	2	0	Genger	1	0	2	0
Vandergrout	0	0	0	0	Simon	0	0	1	0
					Emell	0	0	0	0
Totals	15	15	56	0	Totals	22	5	50	0

Points by Quarters					
1	2	3	4	T	
Open Door	14	13	7	17	51
Columbia	12	8	14	16	50

Three-point goals: Open Door, Deleathis, Walt; Columbia, Wolfe. Junior Varsity: Columbia, 48-20.

foul that put them on the line 15 times in the first half, where they made eight.

"We dug a big hole," said Columbia coach Mickey Verdi. "We've been having problems handling the ball all year. Tonight, we coughed the ball up a lot. We had one of our ballhandlers (Mark Skor) in early foul trouble so he was out."

Both teams have busy week-ends coming up. Open Door hosts Mansfield Christian Friday and

visits Cuyahoga Valley Christian Saturday while Columbia is at

Richmond Heights Friday and at Wellington Saturday.

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